

Ohio Unfair Claims Settlement Practices Reference

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Purpose: Internal reference summarizing Ohio unfair-claims-practices expectations relevant to Meridian Mutual's Personal Auto line.

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This document is a synthetic reference prepared for a software assessment corpus. Figures and practices are presented for realism and internal consistency with this corpus only and should not be relied on as current legal advice.

1. Purpose

Ohio prohibits a defined set of unfair claims settlement practices. This reference translates those prohibitions into concrete claims-handling behavior for Meridian Mutual's adjudication process, cross-referenced against this corpus's own guidance.

2. Practices This Corpus's Process Is Designed to Avoid

- **Misrepresenting policy provisions.** Every adjudication recommendation cites the specific Policy Wording section and Declarations page line relied upon (Claims Adjudication Guidelines, Section 4) — a recommendation without a citation is not a compliant recommendation under this corpus's own process.
- **Failing to acknowledge claims promptly.** Enforced structurally by the claim-acknowledgment timelines in Policy Wording Section 8.1 and the Ohio Regulatory Reference.
- **Denying a claim without a reasonable investigation.** The five-step adjudication sequence exists specifically so a denial is never issued before coverage, exclusions, and the facts of loss have all been checked in order.
- **Compelling a policyholder to litigate by offering substantially less than a reasonable settlement.** The deterministic payout computation (never an LLM estimate) exists to ensure the offered amount is the correct arithmetic result of the policy's own terms, not an arbitrarily low starting offer.

- **Failing to explain a denial.** See Complaint Handling Procedure and the citation requirement above — a denial without a stated policy basis is not permitted.

3. Adverse Determination Notices

Any claim denial or partial denial must be communicated in writing with the specific policy section and exclusion relied upon, consistent with the Complaint Handling Procedure's escalation path for exactly this kind of dispute.

4. Relationship to Complaint Handling

A pattern of complaints alleging any of the practices in Section 2 is itself an indicator warranting review of the underlying adjudication process, not just resolution of the individual complaint — see Complaint Handling Procedure, Section 4.